

acquire, to enhance your ego, or to impress your friends. If you did, sell it or give it away. I suspect most vehicles fall into this category, but we'll talk about vehicles in chapter 8. Third, ask which of your remaining assets have a ready market and are likely to bring in a worthwhile sum. If you have any of those, sell them.

Assets tend to complicate our lives. We insure, store, haul, clean, repair, maintain, and talk about them. We feel guilty if we don't use them or notice them. If you have any assets that don't fit into the three categories above, my advice is to give them to charity or sell them—regardless of how much they're worth. If you can't force yourself to do it now, perhaps you'll be able to do it after a year or two of retirement. If Vicki and I don't use an asset for three years, we presume we should get rid of it: TVs, books, chairs, paintings, clothing, and kitchen appliances. We give those assets to friends or to charity. We enjoy giving and feel we're simplifying our lives.

LET'S LOOK AT AN EXAMPLE

Statistical Abstract of the U.S., published by the Department of Commerce, profiles the asset mix of top wealthholders. Based on these figures, John and Mary Doe's \$435,000 net worth breaks down like this:

Residence, net	\$129,000
Corporate stocks	101,000
Cash	58,000
Bonds	27,000
Notes and receivables	22,000
Other	98,000
Total	\$435,000

With this asset mix, John and Mary Doe work for their assets. Nearly a third of their net worth is in their home.